

PHIL248
Medieval & Renaissance Philosophy

30/09/2025

Introduction:

Tutor asked about personal whatnot, general introduction, get to know others kinda thing.

OED is historical, webster is american

Midterm essay does not include Aquinas, the one after that does include it, essays will be cumulative-ish, continue your work from the previous essay kinda thing, ask about it later on.

07/10/2025

Part 1:

Augustine - Sermon on the Sacking of Rome

Supposed conversion of Constantine.

Old testament, story about the Jews.

Origin of the word "sin"

sin -> *old english* -> synn/sin (violation of divine law)

hattai (sin, failure, error)

peccatum (fault, error, transgression)

3 Holy Men

1. Daniel -> holy celibate people

2. Job -> holy married people

3. Noah -> good men in positions of responsibility

If Daniel confesses his sins, then who can be just?

Story of Sodom

The error must be in the interpretation, not in the text itself. (50 just humans)

Divine rules of justice vs. Human rules of justice

the understanding of justice of God is different than of humans

patitor (to suffer) -> latin

facior (to do / to make) -> french

potestas (power [*the exertion of power*]) <- Augustine specifically uses this
potentia (power that is not necessarily exerted)

poenas (pain, penalty)

Gehenna -> hell (hel from norse)

Introduction of mortality (Garden of Eden and the forbidden tree, [The knowledge of good and evil]
Origin of the human being is imperfect (due to mortality)

Humans fail the rule of perfection as they aren't perfect in origin, thus there are no just (perfect) humans.

To be sinless is a gift of divine grace (can't be earned).

Constantinople was reformed not punished.

So was Rome, it was reformed not punished.

Not the case with Sodom, it was punished, and it is gone, reduced to atoms.

homoousia (same) or homoiousia (similar) -> whether Jesus is same as God or not.

The Great Schism

Part 2:

Boethius -> everything the mind thinks (all come from subject things) either

-> 1. Exists (on its own)

-> if genus(genera) + species exist, they're either

-> a. corporeal

-> b. incorporeal

-> x. separate from bodies

-> y. non-separate from bodies

-> 1. ?

-> 2. lines, genus, species

2. Doesn't Exist (formed by intellect)

-> 1. everything common to several things can't be one thing

-> 2. if they exist, but as multiple, there's no last genus

-> 3. if they exist, but as one thing, they can't be common to many things

-> things are common in three ways

-> 1. in virtue of their parts

-> 2. over time, but used by different owners

-> 3. common to all, but not constituting what's common to all

if the thoughts "genera" + "species" are of subject things as those things are, two things follow

1. they're not just posited by thought

2. they're the truth of those things

if these thoughts aren't adequate, they're empty, + so false -> comes from composition

arrived at via abstraction is not false

14/10/2025

Aristotle and Avicenna

quiddity -> anglocization of *quidditas*

quid -> *what*

quidditas -> *whatness*

to ti en einai -> what it is to be -> essence

whatness roughly translates to essence

quidditas - *essentia* - *realitas* -> there will be differences among these later on, but for now all mean essence

accident -> **particular** combination of matter and form, non essential to a thing except **as** a particular thing

4 Causes of Aristotle (hylomorphic)

1) formal (*morphe*)

2) material (*hyle*)

3) efficient

4) final (*telos*)

Bronze Bowl example again

formal -> the bowlness | material -> bronze | efficient -> bowlmaker | final -> for what it is made for (idk eating from it)

essential | accidental | intrinsic | extrinsic
-> causes

morphe + *hyle* -> essence

It is possible to separate matter and form **in thought**, not in reality (this is how we do geometry etc.).

I.2 (Ibn Sina)

existents -> possible of existence

-> necessary of existence

Possible of existence: *No impossibility follows from its not existing.*

the thing was possible by itself -> but it became necessary by something else (if it exists, it is brought into existence)

Necessary of existence: *Thinking of its non-existence is impossible.*

If everything that's possible of existence requires something else to exist, that thing is the first existent (necessary of existence).

> *Since God is what necessarily exists on its own terms, the quiddity or essence or whatness or reality of God is Gods existence.*

Check p14.

The essence is the existence, and the existence is the essence.

sui seneris -> generates itself <- *not the case (God does not create itself)*

The connection between the two things isn't the same as the two things, Refik had talked about this, god rest his soul.

check p15

> *Read the **whole** I.2 AVICENNA chapter to understand this.*

V.I.7:

'Universal'

- 1) *actually* predicated of many things
- 2) *possibly* predicated of many things (even if they don't exist)
- 3) *nothing prevents* the predication

-> what is universal is something in thought that is not impossible to predicate of many

Logical genus

What's predicated of many species in answer to "What?"

Natural genus

'animal' in so far as it is animal

individual -> outside properties of particular matter designated for the thing

[as universal] individual human being -> [as universal] human being + the accidents that belong to that particular individual

X.4.1:

Life

self-motion

things that move to their own accord

All things that are living have souls.

Soul

- 1) plant
- 2) animal
- 3) rational -> has reason most of all -> listens to reason

Bodies

- 1) **don't** nourish, grow, reproduce
- 2) **do** nourish, grow, reproduce -> not because they are bodily -> in virtue of something over + above their bodiliness -> soul

Souls exist in bodies. Check 146 Notes.

Soul is part of the bodies' constitution.

-> 1) What makes a thing the thing it is in actuality

-> 2) What makes a thing the thing it is in potentiality

4 new definitions of soul ^{p646}

Every form is a realization, but not every realization is a form.

Ibn Sina -> Every form makes real a thing, but not every realization shapes in this way, in the way that morphe indicates.

A king is the realization of a state, but not a form of the state.

Realization: -> 1) what allows a species to become a species in actuality -> soul of a natural body
-> it is the first realization of an actual body from which second realizations emanate
-> 2) things consequent on a species